

Revised Class Unlock System

**Proficiency Tiers Refer to LEVEL, Not Raw EXP
(correction — see Section 0 below)**

<i>L</i>	<i>Tier</i>	<i>Purpose</i>
1	Novice	Single stat, first hour of play
3	Adept	Light combos, early-mid game
6	Expert	Real combos, requires prior class leveling
9	Master	Heavy combos, exotic builds
1	(used only where a stat is meant to be truly maxed)	Prestige-only

Every "value" in every requirement object throughout this document ({ "type": "proficiency", "target": "X", "value": 10 }) means "Level 10 in X," not "10 raw experience points." This distinction matters because it was implemented incorrectly in early milestones — see Section 0.

0. The Level/EXP System (foundational — corrects an implementation gap found during Milestone 5)

This is the core mechanic of the entire game, and it was built wrong in Milestone 1 and almost built wrong again in Milestone 5's Construction skill. Every weapon, magic school, crafting profession, and passive skill in this document shares one underlying system:

- **Level, not a raw counter.** Every trainable stat has a **Level** (0–100, starting at 0/"Unranked") and a separate **current EXP** value tracking progress toward the next level. These are two different numbers. A skill at Level 6 with 40/70 EXP toward Level 7 is not "46" — the tier-gate checks (Novice/Adept/Expert/Master, and every `classLevel/proficiency` requirement anywhere in this doc) compare against **Level**, never against raw accumulated EXP.
- **EXP required per level increases, but not exponentially.** Going from Level 1→2 costs less EXP than Level 50→51, which costs less than Level 99→100 — but the growth is a steady linear-ish climb (a fixed increment added per level), not a runaway exponential curve. Starting point to build against: `expForNextLevel(currentLevel) = baseExp + (currentLevel - 1) × increment`, with illustrative (tunable) values `baseExp = 10, increment = 5`. That means Level 1→2 needs 10 EXP, Level 2→3 needs 15, ... Level 99→100 needs roughly 500. Tune the actual numbers later; the shape of the curve (linear growth, not exponential) is the part that's load-bearing.
- **Every level grants a tangible bonus, not just tier-gate access.** Reaching Level 1 in a weapon isn't just "now I can use higher-tier content" — it should immediately make the character measurably better with that weapon (more accuracy, more attack speed, more damage, or a mix, depending on weapon type), and every subsequent level continues adding to that. This was completely missing from the Milestone 1 implementation — Short Swords proficiency gave zero stat benefit at any level, which contradicts this project's own founding pillar ("for each level up in a skill that character's stats get stronger").
- **Every weapon levels completely independently, always starting at 0.** Picking up a weapon you've never used — even mid-game, even if every other weapon type is heavily leveled — starts that weapon at Level 0/Unranked with zero bonuses, and it climbs the same curve as everything else. A combo class's two component weapons (e.g. Short Swords and Shields for Vanguard) level entirely separately from each other; there's no shared or blended progress between them.
- **This same system underlies weapons, magic schools, crafting professions (including Construction), and the hidden defensive/regen skills** — it's one leveling engine used everywhere, not something reinvented per-skill. Construction's cost/refund tier table (Section 9.4 of `true_grind_gdd.md`) should be read against **Construction's Level**, exactly like every other tier-gated stat in this document — not against a raw incrementing counter.

Per-level stat bonus starting points by weapon category (tunable, but pick a lane per category so the system is consistent):

Category	Suggested Per-Level Bonus
<i>Melee (Katana, Short Swords, Daggers, Mace, Spears, Longswords, Greatswords)</i>	<i>Small mix of +accuracy and +damage per level</i>
<i>Ranged (Bows, Crossbows, Throwing Weapons)</i>	<i>+accuracy and +attack speed per level</i>
<i>Magic schools (Fire/Water/Ice/Earth/Nature/Lightning/Wind/Holy/Dark/Arcane/Healing)</i>	<i>+magic damage and reduced Energy cost per level</i>
<i>Shields</i>	<i>+block/mitigation per level (distinct from, and stacks with, the hidden</i>

Requirement Schema (data-driven, not code)

Every class is defined as a list of requirement objects, ANDed together (unless a class explicitly says "any N of"). Two requirement types:

- {
- "class": "Paladin",
- "requirements": [- { "type": "classLevel", "target": "Vanguard", "value": 10 },
- { "type": "proficiency", "target": "Holy Magic", "value": 30 }
-]
- }

- **proficiency** — raw weapon/magic stat, always available regardless of class history.
- **classLevel** — must have leveled a specific prerequisite class to the given value (not just unlocked it). This is what creates the dependency tree.

Two more requirement types show up later for specific mechanics that don't fit a stat or a class level: **triggerCount** (a lifetime count of a random proc event — used by Luck/Lady Fortune) and **activityCount** (a lifetime count of a deliberate player action — used by Chef's recipe discoveries and Survivalist's camps). Same principle either way: it's a counter on the character, checked like any other requirement.

Adding a new weapon type later just means adding new Tier 0/1 entries with this same schema — no engine changes needed.

Design rule used below: Tier 0 is proficiency-only (nothing to level yet). From Tier 1 onward, classes increasingly lean on **classLevel** requirements from the tier below, so grinding stats alone can't skip the tree — you have to actually play the earlier class.

Tier 0 — Novice (unlockable within the first hour)

Proficiency 10, single stat, no class-level requirement.

Class	Requirement	Fantasy
<i>Swordsman</i>	<i>Katana 10</i>	<i>First swing of the blade</i>
<i>Fencer</i>	<i>Short Swords 10</i>	<i>Quick, light-footed duelist</i>
<i>Guardian</i>	<i>Shields 10</i>	<i>Learning to hold the line</i>
<i>Squire</i>	<i>Longswords 10</i>	<i>Trainee in traditional swordplay</i>
<i>Brute</i>	<i>Greatswords 10</i>	<i>Swinging something too heavy, badly</i>
<i>Cutthroat</i>	<i>Daggers 10</i>	<i>Back-alley opportunist</i>
<i>Marksman</i>	<i>Bows 10</i>	<i>First nocked arrow</i>
<i>Loader</i>	<i>Crossbows 10</i>	<i>Mechanically minded shooter</i>
<i>Bludgeoner</i>	<i>Mace 10</i>	<i>Blunt force enthusiast</i>
<i>Spearman</i>	<i>Spears 10</i>	<i>Basic reach fighter</i>
<i>Skirmisher</i>	<i>Throwing Weapons 10</i>	<i>Hit-and-run thrower</i>

<i>Arcane Initiate</i>	<i>Arcane 10</i>	<i>First spark of raw magic</i>
<i>Ember Adept</i>	<i>Fire Magic 10</i>	<i>Can light a candle. Sometimes a person.</i>
<i>Tide Adept</i>	<i>Water Magic 10</i>	<i>Basic control of water/ice</i>
<i>Sprout Keeper</i>	<i>Nature Magic 10</i>	<i>Talks to plants; plants don't answer yet</i>
<i>Spark Adept</i>	<i>Lightning Magic 10</i>	<i>Static shocks with intent</i>
<i>Gale Adept</i>	<i>Wind Magic 10</i>	<i>Can ruin someone's hair from a distance</i>
<i>Medic</i>	<i>Healing Magic 10</i>	<i>Knows one spell and it's a good one</i>
<i>Acolyte</i>	<i>Holy Magic 10</i>	<i>Recently devout</i>
<i>Cultist</i>	<i>Dark Magic 10</i>	<i>Recently indoctrinated</i>
<i>Grove Walker</i>	<i>Druid Staff 10</i>	<i>Wandering nature novice</i>
<i>Frost Initiate</i>	<i>Ice Magic 10</i>	<i>First brush with true cold (distinct from Water Magic's fluid control)</i>

Stoneheart Initiate	Earth Magic 10	Can crack a rock. On purpose, mostly.
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Excavator	Digging 10	Learning where the ground hides things
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Tier 1 — Adept (early-mid game)

Proficiency 30, light combos. Some carry a soft `classLevel` gate from a Tier 0 class so you've spent a little time in the basic role first — pick a value (Lv 5 shown here) proportional to how fast your leveling curve moves.

Class	Requirements	Fantasy
Ronin	Katana 30 + Swordsman Lv 5	Wandering blade for hire
Samurai	Katana 30 + Shields 10 + Swordsman Lv 5	Armored katana warrior in training
Duelist	Short Swords 30 + Daggers 10	Fast, evasive close-range fighter
Ranger	Bows 30 + Daggers 10	Mobile wilderness scout
Vanguard	Short Swords 30 + Shields 30 + Fencer Lv 5 + Guardian Lv 5	Defensive frontline fighter

<i>Reaver</i>	<i>Greatswords 30 + Brute Lv 5</i>	<i>Heavy-hitting brawler</i>
<i>Shadow Initiate</i>	<i>Daggers 30 + Dark Magic 10</i>	<i>Apprentice assassin</i>
<i>Lancer</i>	<i>Spears 30 + Shields 10</i>	<i>Defensive spear fighter</i>
<i>Sharpshooter</i>	<i>Crossbows 30 + Bows 10</i>	<i>Precision trainee</i>
<i>Battle Medic</i>	<i>Mace 30 + Healing Magic 10</i>	<i>Frontline healer-in-training</i>
<i>Spellswor d</i>	<i>Longswords 30 + Arcane 10</i>	<i>Warrior-mage hybrid trainee</i>
<i>Flamecaller</i>	<i>Fire Magic 30</i>	<i>Apprentice pyromancer</i>
<i>Frostcaller</i>	<i>Water Magic 30</i>	<i>Apprentice aquamancer</i>
<i>Stormtouched</i>	<i>Lightning Magic 30</i>	<i>Apprentice storm mage</i>
<i>Windwalker</i>	<i>Wind Magic 30</i>	<i>Apprentice air mage</i>

<i>Naturalist</i>	<i>Nature Magic 30</i>	<i>Apprentice nature mage</i>
<i>Priest</i>	<i>Holy Magic 30</i>	<i>Devout novice</i>
<i>Warlock</i>	<i>Dark Magic 30</i>	<i>Apprentice of forbidden power</i>
<i>Herbalist</i>	<i>Druid Staff 30 + Nature Magic 10</i>	<i>Nature's apprentice</i>
<i>Thrower</i>	<i>Throwing Weapons 30 + Daggers 10</i>	<i>Quick-handed skirmisher</i>
<i>Scout</i>	<i>Daggers 10 + Bows 15</i>	<i>Deliberately the lowest-threshold hybrid in the game — meant to be the first real class most players unlock, and the one NPC mentors start with</i>

Tier 2 — Expert (requires actual class leveling)

Proficiency 30–60 combos, plus a meaningful `classLevel` requirement (Lv 15–20 shown) from a specific Tier 1 class. This is where the tree stops being "grind stats" and starts being "play the role."

<i>Class</i>	<i>Requirements</i>	<i>Fantasy</i>
<i>Blademaster</i>	<i>Katana 60 + Longswords 30 + Ronin Lv 15</i>	<i>Master of multiple sword styles</i>

<i>Assassin</i>	<i>Daggers 60 + Dark Magic 30 + Shadow Initiate Lv 15</i>	<i>Stealth and lethal precision</i>
<i>Shadowblade</i>	<i>Daggers 30 + Dark Magic 30 + Shadow Initiate Lv 15</i>	<i>Assassin empowered by darkness (magic-leaning)</i>
<i>Arcane Archer</i>	<i>Bows 30 + Arcane 30 + Ranger Lv 15</i>	<i>Magic-infused archer</i>
<i>Storm Archer</i>	<i>Bows 30 + Lightning Magic 30 + Ranger Lv 15</i>	<i>Lightning-infused ranged fighter</i>
<i>Witch Hunter</i>	<i>Crossbows 30 + Holy Magic 30 + Sharpshooter Lv 15</i>	<i>Monster and magic hunter</i>
<i>Knight</i>	<i>Short Swords 60 + Shields 60 + Vanguard Lv 20</i>	<i>Traditional armored warrior</i>
<i>Paladin</i>	<i>Shields 30 + Holy Magic 30 + Vanguard Lv 15</i>	<i>Holy warrior</i>
<i>Dark Knight</i>	<i>Longswords 30 + Dark Magic 30 + Vanguard Lv 15</i>	<i>Warrior empowered by darkness</i>
<i>Juggernaut</i>	<i>Greatswords 60 + Shields 30 + Reaver Lv 15</i>	<i>Nearly unstoppable tank</i>

<i>Battlemage</i>	<i>Longswords 30 + Fire Magic 30 + Arcane 10 + Spellsword Lv 15</i>	<i>Aggressive magic warrior</i>
<i>Storm Lancer</i>	<i>Spears 30 + Lightning Magic 30 + Lancer Lv 15</i>	<i>Lightning-infused spear warrior</i>
<i>Elementalist</i>	<i>Fire Magic 30 + Water Magic 30 + Wind Magic 30</i>	<i>Master of elemental forces</i>
<i>Druid</i>	<i>Druid Staff 30 + Nature Magic 60 + Herbalist Lv 15</i>	<i>Master of nature</i>
<i>Aquamancer</i>	<i>Water Magic 60 + Frostcaller Lv 15</i>	<i>Master of tides, currents, and fluid control</i>
<i>Cryomancer</i>	<i>Ice Magic 60 + Frost Initiate Lv 15</i>	<i>Master of true cold — distinct from Aquamancer's fluid focus</i>
<i>Geomancer</i>	<i>Earth Magic 60 + Stoneheart Initiate Lv 15</i>	<i>Master of stone and terrain</i>
<i>Explorer</i>	<i>Digging 60 + Perception 30 + Excavator Lv 20</i>	<i>Finds what everyone else walks past</i>
<i>Cleric</i>	<i>Holy Magic 30 + Healing Magic 30 + Priest Lv 15</i>	<i>Dedicated holy healer</i>

Tier 3 — Master / Exotic (real commitment)

Proficiency 60–90, plus **classLevel** Lv 20–25 from a Tier 2 class. These should feel like genuinely desirable, hard-earned builds.

<i>Class</i>	<i>Requirements</i>	<i>Fantasy</i>
<i>Sword Saint</i>	<i>Katana 90 + Longswords 60 + Blademaster Lv 25</i>	<i>Legendary master of swordsmanship</i>
<i>Death Knight</i>	<i>Greatswords 90 + Dark Magic 60 + Juggernaut Lv 25 + Dark Knight Lv 20</i>	<i>Terrifying heavy warrior infused with death magic</i>
<i>Celestial Knight</i>	<i>Longswords 90 + Holy Magic 60 + Healing Magic 30 + Knight Lv 25 + Paladin Lv 20</i>	<i>Legendary holy swordsman</i>
<i>Shadow Monk</i>	<i>Short Swords 60 + Daggers 60 + Dark Magic 30 + Assassin Lv 20</i>	<i>Extremely mobile melee assassin</i>
<i>Demon Hunter</i>	<i>Short Swords 60 + Crossbows 60 + Holy Magic 30 + Witch Hunter Lv 20</i>	<i>Specialist in hunting supernatural creatures</i>
<i>Arcane Knight</i>	<i>Longswords 90 + Arcane 90 + Battlemage Lv 25</i>	<i>Channels raw magical energy through weapons</i>
<i>Elemental Knight</i>	<i>Longswords 30 + Fire/Water/Lightning Magic 30 each + Battlemage Lv 20 + Elementalist Lv 20</i>	<i>Imbues weapon with different elements</i>

<i>Tempest</i>	<i>Bows 30 + Lightning Magic 30 + Wind Magic 60 + Storm Archer Lv 20</i>	<i>Ranged warrior who fights alongside storms</i>
<i>Necromancer</i>	<i>Druid Staff 10 + Dark Magic 90 + Warlock Lv 25</i>	<i>Death magic specialist</i>
<i>Nature's Avatar</i>	<i>Druid Staff 60 + Nature Magic 90 + Healing Magic 30 + Druid Lv 25</i>	<i>Near-mythical champion of nature</i>

Tier 4 — Prestige / Mastery (endgame)

*High or maxed proficiency, plus **classLevel** Lv 30 from a Tier 3 class. These should be rare and visible — the equivalent of a max-level badge.*

<i>Class</i>	<i>Requirements</i>	<i>Fantasy</i>
<i>Swordmaster</i>	<i>Katana 100 + Short Swords 60 + Longswords 60 + Sword Saint Lv 30</i>	<i>Peerless blade master</i>
<i>Weaponmaster</i>	<i>Any 5 physical weapon types at 60+ + any two Tier 2+ melee classes Lv 20</i>	<i>Refuses to specialize, and doesn't need to</i>
<i>Archmage</i>	<i>Arcane 100 + any 3 elemental schools at 30+ + Arcane Knight Lv 25 or Elementalist Lv 25</i>	<i>Master of pure magical theory</i>

<i>Grand Paladin</i>	<i>Short Swords 100 + Shields 100 + Holy Magic 90 + Healing Magic 60 + Celestial Knight Lv 30</i>	<i>Pinnacle holy warrior</i>
<i>Dark Lord</i>	<i>Greatswords 100 + Dark Magic 100 + Death Knight Lv 30</i>	<i>Apex of destructive darkness</i>
<i>Archdruid</i>	<i>Druid Staff 100 + Nature Magic 100 + Healing Magic 30 + Nature's Avatar Lv 30</i>	<i>Mythical guardian of nature</i>
<i>Elemental Sovereign</i>	<i>Fire/Water/Lightning/Wind Magic 100 each + Elemental Knight Lv 25 or Tempest Lv 25</i>	<i>Commands all elements at once</i>
<i>Deathbringer</i>	<i>Dark Magic 100 + Greatswords 100 + Daggers 60 + Necromancer Lv 30 or Death Knight Lv 30</i>	<i>Harbinger of death itself</i>

Gathering, Crafting & Passive Skills

*Two gaps had to be filled to make the crafting side actually work: nothing produced raw **ore** or **wood** for smithing/carpentry to consume, and nothing crafted **ranged weapons** once Woodworking was scoped to decorations/furniture only. Added: **Mining**, **Woodcutting**, and a dedicated **Bowyer** profession. **Fishing** is included as an optional extra gathering skill.*

Gathering Skills

Skill

Produces

Feeds Into

<i>Mining</i>	<i>Ore, stone, gems</i>	<i>Blacksmithing, Armorsmithing (heavy), Jewelcrafting</i>
<i>Woodcutting</i>	<i>Logs, timber</i>	<i>Woodworking, Bowyer</i>
<i>Skinning</i>	<i>Hides, pelts</i>	<i>Armorsmithing (light/medium), Bowyer (bowstrings)</i>
<i>Butchering</i>	<i>Meat, organs, bone</i>	<i>Cooking, Alchemy</i>
<i>Foraging</i>	<i>Wild herbs, mushrooms</i>	<i>Alchemy, Cooking</i>
<i>Gardening</i>	<i>Cultivated crops (steadier supply than Foraging)</i>	<i>Cooking, Alchemy</i>
<i>Animal Husbandry</i>	<i>Wool, milk, eggs, livestock</i>	<i>Cooking, Tailoring, mounts</i>
<i>Fishing</i>	<i>Fish, aquatic reagents</i>	<i>Cooking, Alchemy</i>
<i>Digging</i>	<i>Buried treasure, rare ore veins, relics</i>	<i>Explorer class, Jewelcrafting, quest items</i>

Crafting Professions — Recipe Tiers

Each profession uses the same 10/30/60/90 scale as combat proficiency, so a Tier N recipe requires Tier N proficiency in the profession — consistent with everything else in this system.

Profession	Tier 0 (10)	Tier 1 (30)	Tier 2 (60)	Tier 3 (90)	Gathered From
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<i>Blacksmithing</i>	<i>Basic Katana/Daggers/Mace</i>	<i>Longswords, Spears</i>	<i>Greatswords, reinforced blades</i>	<i>Legendary-tier weapons</i>	<i>Mining</i>
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<i>Armorsmithing</i>	<i>Light armor</i>	<i>Medium armor</i>	<i>Heavy armor</i>	<i>Masterwork plate (all weights)</i>	<i>Mining + Skinning</i>
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<i>Bowyer</i>	<i>Basic Bows</i>	<i>Crossbows, Throwing Weapons</i>	<i>Reinforced/composite bows</i>	<i>Legendary-tier weapons</i>	<i>Woodcutting + Skinning</i>
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Woodworking	Simple furniture	Decorative shelves, basics using sets	Fine furniture, statues	Masterwork housing centerpiece	Woodcutting
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Alchemy	Minor potions	Standard potions, advanced transmutations, basics transmutations	Strong potions, advanced transmutations	Elixirs, granite transmutation ion	Foraging + Gardening + Butchering
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Enchanting	Minor stat imbues	Elemental imbues	Set-bonus imbues	Legendary slot s	Alchemy + Magic + Enchanting + Proficiency + Finishing
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item

Tailoring / Jewelry crafting	Cloth basics, simple rings	Robes , gem stones et rings	Enchant-ready caster gear, amulets	Legendary accessories	Animal Husbandry (clothes) + Mining (gems)
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Cooking	— recipes are discovered , not tier-unlocked. Proficiency raises discovery odds and dish quality ceiling instead. See the Chef section below.	Butchering + Foraging + Gardening + Animal Husbandry + Fishing
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<i>Stonemason</i>	<i>Basic stone shaping, Bricks (refined from Stone)</i>	<i>Reinforced stone fittings</i>	<i>Fine stonework, statuary</i>	<i>Master working stone architecture</i>	<i>Mining</i>
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Crafting Mastery Classes

Same *classLevel* pattern as combat: each rank requires proficiency **and** having leveled the previous rank.

<i>Profession</i>	<i>Apprentice (10)</i>	<i>Journeyman (30, req. Apprentice Lv 10)</i>	<i>Master (60, req. Journeyman Lv 15)</i>	<i>Grandmaster (90, req. Master Lv 25)</i>
<i>Blacksmithing</i>	<i>Apprentice Smith</i>	<i>Journeyman Smith</i>	<i>Master Smith</i>	<i>Grandmaster Smith</i>
<i>Armorsmithing</i>	<i>Apprentice</i>	<i>Journeyman Armorer</i>	<i>Master Armorer</i>	<i>Grandmaster Armorer</i>

	Armor er			
Bowyer	Apprentic e Bowyer	Journeyman Bowyer	Master Bowyer	Grandmaster Bowyer
Woodworkin g	Apprentic e Carpe nter	Journeyman Carpenter	Master Carpenter	Grandmaster Carpenter
Alchemy	Apprentic e Alche mist	Journeyman Alchemist	Master Alchemist	Archalchemist
Enchanting	Apprentic e Encha nter	Journeyman Enchanter	Master Enchanter	Runeweaver
Tailoring / Jewelcra fting	Apprentic e Artisa n	Journeyman Artisan	Master Artisan	Grandmaster Artisan
Cooking	Apprentic e Cook	Line Cook	Chef	Executive Chef

Stonemason	Apprentice Stone mason	Journeyman Stonemason	Master Stonemason	Grandmaster Stonemason
Construction	Apprentice Builder	Journeyman Builder	Master Builder	Grandmaster Builder

Note on Construction: unlike every other profession in this table, Construction doesn't unlock recipe tiers — it applies a flat, universal **build-cost reduction and demolish-refund increase** across all buildable categories as it levels (full table in [true_grind_gdd.md](#) Section 9.4). It's trained by placing and demolishing structures directly, not by using a crafting station.

That's **28 crafting classes**.

Crafting × Combat Hybrids

A few classes that reward players who invest in both a craft and a combat/magic line — good "why would I ever level a profession" hooks.

Class	Requirements	Fantasy
Battlesmith	Blacksmithing 30 + any weapon proficiency 60 + Journeyman Smith Lv 15	Fights with weapons of their own making
Runeblade	Enchanting 30 + Arcane 60 + Journeyman Enchanter Lv 15	Carves living magic into blades
Alchemical Bomber	Alchemy 30 + Throwing Weapons 60 + Journeyman Alchemist Lv 15	Turns volatile potions into weapons

<i>Beastmaster</i>	<i>Animal Husbandry 60 + Taming 60 + Bows 30</i>	<i>Fights alongside a tamed companion</i>
<i>Herbwarden</i>	<i>Gardening 60 + Foraging 60 + Nature Magic 30</i>	<i>Cultivator whose garden magic bites back</i>

That's 5 hybrid classes.

Passive Skills

<i>Skill</i>	<i>Effect</i>	<i>Pairs With</i>
<i>Accuracy</i>	<i>Increases hit chance</i>	<i>↔ Evasion</i>
<i>Evasion</i>	<i>Increases dodge chance</i>	<i>↔ Accuracy</i>
<i>Perception</i>	<i>Finds hidden treasure, traps, secrets</i>	<i>↔ Stealth</i>
<i>Stealth</i>	<i>Reduces detection radius/chance</i>	<i>↔ Perception</i>
<i>Life Steal</i>	<i>Heals a % of damage dealt</i>	<i>↔ Critical Strike</i>
<i>Critical Strike</i>	<i>Increases critical hit chance/damage</i>	<i>↔ Life Steal</i>

<i>Lockpicking</i>	<i>Opens containers/doors without keys</i>	<i>Perception</i>
<i>Taming</i>	<i>Allows capturing and bonding wild creatures</i>	<i>Animal Husbandry</i>
<i>Haggling / Appraisal</i>	<i>Better prices, reveals true item value/rarity</i>	<i>Luck</i>
Luck	<i>Unique mechanic — see below</i>	<i>Everything (loot, crit, gathering yield)</i>

Luck — how it actually works

Every character starts with a very low base Luck (near 0%). On qualifying actions — loot rolls, crit checks, gather yields, anything with a random outcome — the game rolls against the character's **current** Luck value as the chance to "proc." On a successful proc, Luck increases by a small flat amount (**+0.1**). This is the loop you described: Luck is both the trigger chance and the thing that grows from triggering, so it climbs slowly and entirely through play, never by direct investment.

To make "trigger it 5 times" and "reach 10 Luck" land at roughly the same moment rather than one gate being trivial and the other absurd, split the proc into two tiers:

- **Normal proc** — the +0.1 Luck gain described above. Reaching 10.0 Luck from ~0 takes roughly **100 successful procs**.
- **Fortune Trigger** — a rarer flag on the successful proc roll (recommend ~1-in-20, i.e. 5% of normal procs). This is the big, visible "Fortune smiles on you" moment — extra loot roll, on-screen flourish — and is counted separately as the character's lifetime Fortune Trigger count.

At a 1-in-20 rate, by the time a character has accumulated ~100 normal procs (i.e. reached ~10 Luck), they'll have had ~5 Fortune Triggers on average — so your two conditions naturally converge instead of one being reached hundreds of procs before the other. That's the requirement type this needs, added to the schema:

- {
- "class": "Lady Fortune (skill tree)",

- "requirements": [
- { "type": "proficiency", "target": "Luck", "value": 10 },
- { "type": "triggerCount", "target": "Fortune Trigger", "value": 5 }
-]
- }

triggerCount is a new requirement type: a lifetime counter on the character, separate from any stat value, incremented by a specific tagged event.

Lady Fortune Skill Tree (unlocked via the above)

<i>Node</i>	<i>Effect</i>
<i>Fortune's Favor</i>	<i>Increases normal Luck proc chance slightly</i>
<i>Golden Touch</i>	<i>Increases loot rarity/quantity from defeated mobs</i>
<i>Jackpot</i>	<i>Fortune Triggers have a chance to duplicate a rare drop</i>
<i>Fortune's Shield</i>	<i>Fortune Triggers can also negate an incoming critical hit</i>
<i>Lady Fortune's Blessing (capstone)</i>	<i>Fortune Triggers grant a brief buff to nearby allies, not just the character who rolled it</i>

Passive-Skill Hybrid Classes

<i>Class</i>	<i>Requirements</i>	<i>Fantasy</i>
<i>Trickster</i>	<i>Daggers 30 + Luck 10</i>	<i>Relies on blades and pure chance</i>

Bounty Hunter	Crossbows 30 + Perception 30	Tracks marks others can't find
Vampire	Dark Magic 30 + Life Steal 60	Sustains through stolen life force
Treasure Hunter	Perception 60 + Luck 10 + Lockpicking 30	Nothing stays hidden or locked for long

That's **4 more classes**.

Hidden Defensive & Regen Skills

This reuses the exact mechanic Luck already established — a hidden stat starting near 0%, a low per-action chance to proc based on its current value, +0.1 per successful proc — and applies it to **Resilience**, **Parry**, **Block**, **Counterattack**, **Health Regen**, and **Mana Regen**. Two additions specific to this set:

1. **Weapon/tool eligibility.** Unlike Luck (which can proc on anything), these only proc while the character has the right gear equipped — you can't grind Parry with a bow out, and you can't grind Block without a shield.
2. **Class head-starts.** Certain classes grant a hidden bonus toward a specific skill's proc chance from the moment you unlock the class — representing innate aptitude — even though the skill itself stays invisible to the player until it hits Level 1.

The Six Skills

Skill	Procs When	Requires Equipped	Effect Once Unlocked (Lv 1 / 30 / 60 / 90)
Resilience	Character takes a hit	Nothing (armor-agnostic)	2% dmg reduction → 5% → 8% + brief mitigation chance

→ 12% + rare full negation

<i>Parry</i>	<i>Attacked in melee</i>	<i>A parry-capable weapon (Katana, Short Swords, Longswords, Greatswords, Spears, Daggers)</i>	<i>Unlocks manual parry window → opens counter window reliably → partial dmg reflect → perfect parry stuns attacker</i>
<i>Block</i>	<i>Attacked while a shield is up</i>	<i>Shield</i>	<i>Chip dmg reduction → reduced stamina cost → negates crits → reflects a % of blocked dmg</i>
<i>Counterattack</i>	<i>Successfully dodge/parry/ block an attack</i>	<i>Any melee weapon</i>	<i>Small chance to auto-counter → higher chance/dmg → counters can crit → counters chain to a second hit</i>
<i>Health Regen</i>	<i>Passive tick (out of combat)</i>	<i>Nothing</i>	<i>Passive regen out of combat → light regen in combat → regen rate increases → burst heal chance at low HP</i>
<i>Mana Regen</i>	<i>Passive tick, mana pool present</i>	<i>Any magic-school proficiency</i>	<i>Passive regen out of combat → light regen in combat → regen rate</i>

increases → burst
mana chance at low
mana

Unlock Flow (matches Luck's model exactly)

- {
- "skill": "Parry",
- "hiddenGrowth": {
- "eligibleWhen": { "equippedAny": ["Katana", "Short Swords", "Longswords", "Greatswords", "Spears", "Daggers"] },
- "procChance": "currentValue + classBonus",
- "gainPerProc": 0.1,
- "unlockThreshold": 10
- }
- }

Below the Lv 1 threshold (value ≥ 10) the skill is completely hidden from the UI — the player just occasionally "gets lucky" defensively with no visible explanation, exactly like early Luck. At Lv 1 it reveals itself, names itself, and becomes a normal trainable stat that keeps climbing through the same 10/30/60/90 tiers as everything else.

Class Head-Starts

A class can grant a flat hidden bonus added to a skill's proc chance from the moment it's unlocked — this doesn't unlock the skill outright, it just means that class reaches Lv 1 in far fewer procs than a character with no aptitude.

- { "class": "Guardian", "hiddenBonus": { "skill": "Block", "value": 2.0 } }

Class Family

Guardian, Vanguard, Knight, Paladin

Hidden Bonus Skill

Block

Squire, Ronin, Blademaster, Sword Saint

Parry

Brute, Reaver, Juggernaut, Berserker-line

Resilience

Duelist, Assassin, Shadowblade, Fencer

Counterattack

Any Tier 0 magic-school class (Ember Adept, Tide Adept, etc.)

Mana Regen

Medic, Battle Medic, Cleric, Priest

Health Regen

This gives every class a bit of hidden personality even before a player notices — a Guardian who blocks "by accident" more often than a mage would, without either of them knowing why yet.

New Hybrid Classes from Defensive Skills

<i>Class</i>	<i>Requirements</i>	<i>Fantasy</i>
<i>Bulwark</i>	<i>Shields 60 + Block 30 + Resilience 30</i>	<i>Immovable wall of a person</i>
<i>Riposte Master</i>	<i>Parry 30 + Counterattack 30 + any bladed weapon 60</i>	<i>Punishes every mistake an enemy makes</i>
<i>Vitality Warden</i>	<i>Health Regen 30 + Mana Regen 30 + Healing Magic 30</i>	<i>Sustains a whole fight through sheer recovery</i>

That's 3 more classes.

Chef & Survivalist — Activity-Discovery Classes

Both of these break from the tier-unlock pattern on purpose: Chef learns by **experimenting**, and Survivalist learns by **doing a specific thing repeatedly out in the world**, not by grinding a stat in a menu. That's exactly why the **activityCount** requirement type exists — it counts a deliberate player action rather than a stat or a random proc.

Chef

Recipe discovery, not recipe unlocking. Every other profession unlocks its recipe list automatically at a proficiency tier. Cooking doesn't — a player combines ingredients at a cooking station (or campfire, tying in nicely with Survivalist below) and has a chance to discover a new dish, based on:

- Whether that specific ingredient combination has been tried before (first attempt has the discovery chance; repeats just cook the already-known dish).
- Cooking proficiency (raises both the discovery chance and the maximum quality tier reachable).
- Ingredient rarity — **monster drops** (a Wolf Fang, a Slime Core, a Wyrmling Scale) behave as high-value "wildcard" ingredients that unlock dishes plain foraged/gardened ingredients can't reach on their own. This is what makes hunting feed into cooking instead of the two systems living in isolation.

Once discovered, a recipe is permanently known and can be cooked normally like any other profession's recipe.

Dish Quality

Every cook has a chance, per dish, to produce one of four quality tiers — this is what "boosts how much it heals" actually means mechanically:

Quality	Relative Heal/Buffer Potency
---------	------------------------------

Com m o n	1.0× (baseline)
Good	1.25×
Excel le nt	1.5×
Perfe ct	2.0× + short bonus buff

Base chance of each tier is weighted by Cooking proficiency; Chef-line skills (below) shift those odds further and independently of raw proficiency.

Chef Skills

Skill	Type	Effect
<i>Forager's Palate</i>	Passive	<i>Increases chance of rare monster ingredient drops from kills</i>
<i>Butcher's Eye</i>	Passive	<i>Increases quantity of Cooking-usable drops from Butchering</i>

v
e

Bulk Cooking

Acti
v
e

Chance to produce extra portions from a single set of ingredients

Gourmet Touch

Acti
v
e

Shifts dish-quality odds toward Excellent/Perfect

Iron Stomach
(party buff)

Pa
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Nearby allies who eat the Chef's dishes get a longer buff duration

Chef Class Tiers

Class

Requirements

Fantasy

*Apprentic
e
Cook*

Cooking 10

*Burns things occasionally,
means well*

*Line
Cook*

*Cooking 30 + Apprentice Cook Lv 10 + 5
recipes discovered*

*Competent, reliable,
growing a real
repertoire*

<i>Chef</i>	<i>Cooking 60 + Line Cook Lv 15 + 20 recipes discovered (incl. 1+ using a monster ingredient)</i>	<i>Cooks dishes that actually matter in a fight</i>
<i>Executive Chef</i>	<i>Cooking 90 + Chef Lv 25 + 50 recipes discovered (incl. 5+ using monster ingredients)</i>	<i>Their dishes are the reason the guild survives dungeon runs</i>

That's **4 new crafting classes** (folded into the crafting mastery total).

Survivalist

Unlocked entirely through action, not a stat. A player sets up a camp while inside a dungeon run (consuming Woodcutting/Foraging materials, taking a moment of vulnerability to do it) — the camp grants the party a temporary safe zone: faster Health/Mana Regen ticks, a respawn point, and a short buff on breaking camp to continue. Doing this enough times is the unlock condition:

- {
- "class": "Survivalist",
- "requirements": [
- { "type": "activityCount", "target": "Dungeon Camp Setup", "value": 5 }
-]
- }

No proficiency or class-level gate on the base unlock — this is deliberately the one class line anyone can stumble into just by playing cautiously and setting up camp instead of pushing through exhausted.

Survivalist Skills

<i>Skill</i>	<i>Type</i>	<i>Effect</i>
<i>Quick Camp</i>	<i>Active</i>	<i>Reduces camp setup time and resource cost</i>

<i>Well-Rested</i>	<i>Passive</i>	<i>Camp buffs last longer and grant a small bonus to XP gain</i>
<i>Trailblazer's Sense</i>	<i>Passive</i>	<i>Increases Perception while camping and briefly after breaking camp</i>
<i>Emergency Shelter</i>	<i>Active (Tier 3+)</i>	<i>Allows setting up a rough camp even mid-combat, at high resource cost, as a last resort</i>

Survivalist Class Tiers

<i>Class</i>	<i>Requirements</i>	<i>Fantasy</i>
<i>Survivalist</i>	<i>5 Dungeon Camps Setup</i>	<i>Knows how to not die between fights</i>
<i>Trailblazer</i>	<i>15 Camps + Foraging 30 + Woodcutting 30 + Survivalist Lv 10</i>	<i>The one the party trusts to find the safe spot</i>
<i>Wilderness Warden</i>	<i>30 Camps + Foraging 60 + Woodcutting 60 + Trailblazer Lv 20</i>	<i>Turns any dungeon corridor into a fortified rest stop</i>
<i>Grand Survivalist</i>	<i>50 Camps + Nature Magic 60 + Perception 60 + Wilderness Warden Lv 30</i>	<i>Legendary guide — parties seek them out before the hardest runs</i>

That's 4 more classes.

Notes / open decisions for you to tune

1. **Max class level & curve.** Everything above assumes classes have their own level (separate from weapon proficiency). Decide the level cap and how fast it scales — the Lv 5/15/20/25/30 gates above are placeholders proportional to a rough 1–30 or 1–50 curve. Adjust to match your actual leveling pace.
2. **AND vs OR between classLevel prerequisites.** A few Tier 3/4 classes list two prerequisite classes (e.g. Celestial Knight needs both Knight AND Paladin). Decide per-class whether that's a strict AND or whether "either" is acceptable — AND makes the class rarer and more meaningful, OR makes it more accessible from two different playstyles.
3. **Should proficiency ever decay or reset on respec?** Not addressed here — worth deciding before players start hybrid-building, since it affects whether Weaponmaster-style "any 5 at 60+" classes are grindy or trivially achievable by a completionist.
4. **Throwing Weapons is now covered** (Skirmisher → Thrower), but it doesn't yet have an Expert/Master-tier class of its own — worth adding one if it's meant to be a first-class combat style rather than a support stat.
5. **Luck's proc formula needs a curve, not a flat %.** Using the current Luck value as a straight percentage chance means Luck approaching 100 would proc almost constantly — you'll likely want a soft cap or diminishing-returns curve (e.g. effective chance = $\text{Luck} \times 0.5$, or a log curve past 20) so late-game Luck doesn't spiral.
6. **Fortune Trigger rate (1-in-20) is a starting guess**, tuned specifically so "10 Luck" and "5 triggers" land together — if you change how fast Luck grows per proc, recalculate this ratio so the two Lady Fortune conditions stay roughly simultaneous rather than one gating the other.
7. **Enchanting and Tailoring/Jewelcrafting are marked optional** — only add them if you have an accessory slot and want casters to have a non-hide light-armor path; otherwise Armorsmithing's Light tier already covers cloth-adjacent gear.
8. **Combat log noise for hidden procs.** A Resilience/Parry/Counterattack proc happening invisibly pre-unlock still needs some in-game effect (reduced damage, a dodge, an extra hit) even though the player doesn't see a skill name yet — decide whether that shows as generic combat text ("You brace against the blow") or nothing at all, since total silence makes the eventual Lv 1 reveal less satisfying.
9. **Stacking class head-starts.** Decide whether a class can only ever grant one hidden bonus (as tabled above) or whether multiclassing/respec history should stack bonuses from every class a character has ever unlocked — the latter rewards long-term characters but makes early Lv-1 unlocks less distinctive per current class.
10. **Recipe discovery needs a search-space design, not just randomness.** With monster drops as wildcard ingredients, decide whether discovery is truly random per combo (simple, but can feel like slot-machine cooking) or hinted (e.g., an ingredient's flavor tag

suggests what it pairs well with) — hinted discovery rewards experimentation more than luck and fits the "chef" fantasy better long-term.

11. **What counts as a valid "Dungeon Camp Setup."** *Decide whether camps only count toward Survivalist's activityCount inside actual instanced dungeons, or also in open-world dangerous zones — this changes how fast casual players reach the unlock versus dungeon-focused ones.*
12. **Fixed a real conflict:** *Longswords are tagged 2H in the weapon list, but Vanguard, Knight, and Grand Paladin originally paired Longswords with a Shield, which needs a free off-hand. Swapped those three to Short Swords + Shield instead, keeping Longsword as a dedicated no-shield 2H line (Squire → Dark Knight → Sword Saint → Celestial Knight). Worth double-checking no other combo class makes the same mistake as new ones get added.*
13. **Water/Ice/Earth are now three separate schools,** *not one — Aquamancer (Water Magic) governs fluid/current control, Cryomancer (Ice Magic) governs true cold, and Geomancer (Earth Magic) governs stone/terrain. Elementalist-line classes (Elementalist, Elemental Knight, Elemental Sovereign) currently only reference the original four schools (Fire/Water/Lightning/Wind) — decide whether Ice and Earth get folded into those recipes too or stay as their own separate specialist path.*

*Total: 74 combat classes + 40 crafting mastery classes (incl. the 4-tier Chef line, the 4-tier Stonemason line, and the new 4-tier Construction line) + 5 crafting/combat hybrids + 4 passive-skill hybrids + 3 defensive-skill hybrids + 4 Survivalist tiers + 8 new classes (Scout, Frost Initiate, Stoneheart Initiate, Excavator, Aquamancer, Cryomancer, Geomancer, Explorer) = **138 classes**, plus 9 gathering skills, 10 crafting professions (added Stonemason and Construction), 10 passive skills, 6 hidden defensive/regen skills, and 2 activity/experimentation-based systems layered on the same core requirement schema.*

Cross-reference: *Dual Wielding (unlockable via any 2 one-handed melee weapons at proficiency 30, per-character, with a scaling accuracy penalty as it levels) and the Skill Book cross-class-learning mechanic are both specified in [true_grind_gdd.md](#) Sections 4.3 and 12.0 rather than duplicated here.*

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